

Despite this (or maybe because of it, I don't know?) people began asking for my help managing their assets right after the GFC. That was back in 2008–09 and \$5 billion ago.

Do you need help, and if so, how much? Here are the factors you should consider.

1. How complicated are your financial circumstances?

The simplest financial situation is a young, single working person who is a renter. At the other end of the scale is a successful entrepreneur who owns their own company(s), facing large capital gains reflecting the sale of a business, has children and grandchildren to pass wealth to, has multiple sources of income, and a fairly involved tax filing (including K-1 distributions, loss carryforwards, etc.) to go with it. They own multiple real estate properties in the US and abroad. They work with many attorneys, accountants, and advisors. They have maxed out all of their qualified tax-deferred accounts, own numerous investment portfolios at different firms, have completed wills and trusts, own various insurance policies, and are involved in major philanthropic endeavors.

You are likely in between these endpoints. The more complicated your circumstances, the more likely you would benefit from professional help. Even people who can do this themselves often have better things to do with their time.

2. What are your long-term (five plus years) financial goals?

These are the most common answers, listed here in order of complexity:

- Saving to buy a home.
- Paying for children's college.